

Procedural Representation and Elite Backlash: Experiences of Everyday Discrimination Faced by Scheduled Caste Village Presidents in India

Amol Shaila Suresh, MSc Social Research Methods, LSE

Abstract:

When India's 73rd Constitutional Amendment took effect, Scheduled Castes were elected to village leadership positions in unprecedented numbers. However, procedural representation does not simply translate into substantive empowerment, as SC leaders encounter dynamic resistance aimed to undermine their de facto authority. In this article, I investigate how independent SC village presidents in Bihar, India – those who resist proxy status and exercise authority in their own right – experience and perceive backlash. This study draws on semi-structured, in-depth interviews with three SC village presidents (or *mukhiyas*¹) who have resisted traditional proxy leadership arrangements. The findings reveal that: (1) formal procedural representation often fails to generate substantive authority, and (2) independent SC leaders who resist proxy status face a multi-dimensional backlash – ranging from systematic bureaucratic obstruction to social microaggressions and the physical destruction of symbolic icons. This research highlights the systematic ways substantive democracy is undermined through everyday exclusion and the necessity of transforming underlying power structures alongside institutional reforms.

Keywords: Political Reservation, Caste, Local Governance, Backlash, India

Introduction

India's 73rd Constitutional Amendment of 1992 fundamentally transformed rural governance by creating approximately 250,000 rural republics through Panchayati Raj Institutions², with mandatory political reservations for historically marginalized groups including Scheduled Castes³, Scheduled Tribes⁴, and women (George et al., 2024). This decentralization policy devolved administrative and financial powers to village councils, enabling direct participation of rural citizens in local development decisions. Mahatma Gandhi, long ago, advocated for decentralizing power to villages, empowering common people and creating self-governing communities. On the other side, Dr. B. R. Ambedkar, the architect of India's Constitution, fundamentally challenged this

¹ *Mukhiya* is a Hindi term for the elected head of a village council (gram panchayat). I use words 'village president' and '*mukhiya*' interchangeably.

² Panchayati Raj Institutions (PRIs) are India's system of local self-government in rural areas, created as a three-tier structure by the 73rd Constitutional Amendment (1992) to promote decentralization, participatory democracy and rural development.

³ Scheduled Castes (SCs), constitutionally designated communities formerly known as "untouchables" and self-identified as *Dalits* ("oppressed"), historically subjected to severe social exclusion and occupational segregation under the Hindu caste system. SCs comprise approximately 16-17% of India's population (Census of India, 2011).

⁴ Scheduled Tribes (STs) are constitutionally designated indigenous communities, traditional forest-dwelling groups with distinct cultural identities outside the caste system, comprising 8.6% of India's population.

romanticized vision of village democracy. Ambedkar famously warned, “[...] these village republics have been the ruination of India... What is the village but a sink of localism, a den of ignorance, narrow-mindedness and communalism” (Ambedkar, 2004: 486). He argued that these institutions are structurally prejudiced to benefit upper-caste interests and intensify caste-based exploitation. The tension between Ambedkar's skepticism and Gandhi's idealization of village self-governance frames contemporary challenge in India's local democratic institutions, particularly the gap between procedural representation and substantive empowerment for marginalized communities.

Comisso (1997) distinguishes procedural democracy, such as formal structures of elections and political quotas, from substantive democracy, which encompasses actual exercise of power, rights and meaningful participation in decision-making. While procedural understandings of democracy focus on methods of decision-making, such as voting, representation, and accountability, substantive democracy concerns itself with the actual outcomes and protections delivered to citizens, including economic and social rights (Spicker, 2008). The 73rd Amendment successfully created procedural mechanisms through devolution of power and mandatory reservations to oppressed groups, yet elected representatives face persistent challenges translating *de jure* authority into *de facto* power (Behera, 2011).

The distinction between *de jure* and *de facto* authority constitutes the central focus of this study: independent leadership (versus proxy). Both proxy and independent *mukhiyas* hold the same *de jure* authority granted by election. However, they differ in exercising *de facto* power. In a proxy arrangement, dominant-caste elites retain control by either supporting a pliable SC candidate expected to cede decision-making to them once elected, or by coercing an elected *mukhiya* into compliance, so actual power stays with them. The existing scholarship extensively documents this elite capture in Panchayati Raj, wherein *de facto* authority is controlled by installing compliant candidates from reserved groups (Waheduzzaman et al. 2018, Rajasekhar et al. 2018). These proxies, typically wives, daughters-in-law, or bonded labourers of the local power elites, hold office nominally while actual authority remains with dominant-caste men. Independent *mukhiyas* refuse this cession and seek to exercise power on their own. This study concerns this group of SC presidents who decline proxy status and assert independent authority.

Recent quantitative evidence from rural India finds that leaders elected through quotas are systematically less central in decision-making than their non-quota counterparts and interference with their work is widely seen as legitimate (Heinze et al., 2025). Heinze (2025) shows that electoral reform does not dislodge elite dominance but simply change its form. In a survey experiment, Heinze (2025) finds that SC presidents, when they assert their authority autonomously, are perceived as most likely to face threats and violence from caste elites. Teltumbde (2011)

describes how autonomous *Dalit*⁵ leaders, who refuse to take proxy status, have to face shame, obstruction and in extreme cases violence. One such incident is that of Krishnaveni, a *Dalit* woman village president who faced a deadly attack by dominant caste people of her village for asserting her position (Rao, 2017).

Such power dynamics are not unique to caste. The literature on gender reveals a parallel dynamic of male backlash on women empowerment, where women's entry into male-dominated spaces often triggers patriarchal backlash. Berry et al. (2020) document that Kenya's gender quota implementation triggered patriarchal backlash including physical attacks and public stripping of women politicians, verbal abuse labeling politically active women as "prostitutes." Girl education programs or improved labor market outcomes for women often trigger male backlash in the form psychological violence, financial control and domestic abuse (Cullen et al. 2024, Erten and Keskin 2018, Ericsson 2020).

This study draws on Mansbridge and Shames' (2008) theory of backlash as "dynamic resistance," the use of coercive power by dominant individual or groups to regain lost capacity to enact their preferences and interests when challenged by marginalized individual or groups. When *Dalit mukhiyas* exercise independent authority in India's Panchayat Raj Institutions through political reservations or otherwise, they threaten the naturalized privileges of dominant castes, who may react with backlash manifesting as microaggressions, violence, and exclusionary practices to reassert the lost power as capacity. I also draw from Sue et. al.'s (2007) framework of racial microaggressions – microassault, microinsult and microinvalidation – to understand subtle forms of discrimination.

These backlash patterns suggest a broader phenomenon: when policies are enacted to empower historically marginalized groups without transforming underlying power structures, entrenched elites often respond with intensified oppression to maintain substantive control. While extreme cases of caste-based violence are episodically recorded, literature on backlash against caste-based empowerment remains underdeveloped. This study addresses this gap by examining backlash against *Dalit* panchayat leaders in India who exercise authority independently rather than serving as proxies for dominant castes. This study therefore asks: how do independently acting *Dalit* panchayat leaders experience and perceive backlash in their everyday political and social interactions while holding office? This question addresses a critical empirical gap by focusing on SC leaders who occupy the contested middle ground between elite capture and direct physical violence.

⁵ *Dalits*, formerly known as "untouchables", represent a historically marginalized group often considered outside the traditional Hindu caste hierarchy (outcastes). *Dalits* are legally coded as Scheduled Castes in the Indian Constitution. I will use "*Dalits*" and "Scheduled Castes" interchangeably.

Data and Methods

In January 2026, I conducted semi-structured in-depth interviews with three *Dalit* village presidents in Bihar, India to investigate their lived experiences of navigating everyday backlash while holding office. This purposive sampling (Patton, 2002) was essential because *Dalits* constitute the most historically discriminated group in India's caste hierarchy, providing critical insights into how entrenched inequities persist despite empowerment measures. I restricted the sample to only male participants because as a male researcher, I recognized that women *mukhiyas* might be reluctant to discuss sensitive experiences such as sexual harassment, potentially constraining data collection depth (Berry et al., 2020). This limitation restricts access to important dimensions of discrimination intersecting caste and gender. Interviewees were approached because they were: (a) scheduled caste men, (b) elected head of the village council, (c) exercising authority independently rather than serving as proxy candidates. I contacted the participants through a local organization working in Bihar. Each interview was conducted in Hindi via WhatsApp calls; audio recorded with informed consent and lasted approximately 40-60 minutes. The transcriptions were then coded for patterns and common themes manually (Braun and Clarke, 2006). While I use Sue et al.'s (2007) microaggressions taxonomy as sensitizing framework, I employed inductive, data-driven coding rather than deductively applying predefined categories.

Ethics and Reflexivity

I obtained verbal consent from all participants before beginning interviews by audio recording their agreement after clearly explaining the research objectives, their right to withdraw at any time, and how their data would be used. The purpose of the study was transparently communicated to avoid any deception. I assured confidentiality to participants by using pseudonyms, with no identifying information appearing in publication of results. Beyond formal procedures, I provided a comfortable and confidential space for participants to discuss sensitive topics including caste-based discrimination and violence, without fear of about information reaching local power holders who might retaliate.

The interviews contained references to violence, including one participant's father being murdered during a leftist movement and another recounting a fourteen-year-old *Dalit* girl's death in caste-based violence. While such accounts are deeply troubling, violence and premature death remain sadly commonplace experiences within *Dalit* communities in rural Bihar, forming part of the collective social reality that shapes political consciousness. Throughout interviews, I remained observant of participants' emotional state, monitoring for signs of distress when they recalled difficult lived experiences or mentioned incidents of violence. I was prepared to immediately pause or stop interviews if participants showed discomfort.

As a researcher from non-SC background affiliated with an elite international institute conducting research on *Dalit* communities, I recognize the inherent power asymmetries and ethical responsibilities this positionality entails. I do not share the lived experiences of caste-based oppression. I approach this research with awareness that my understanding of caste discrimination remains partial and mediated through intellectual engagement rather than embodied knowledge. I acknowledge the limitations of my outsider perspective and remain deeply conscious about being positioned as an extractive researcher who benefits professionally from documenting others' suffering. My ideological commitment to anti-caste politics and decentralized self-governance motivated this research. I recognize that this normative position may predispose me to sympathize with *Dalit* village presidents, potentially influencing how I interpret observational data. Throughout analysis, I remained reflexive about this tendency, grounding interpretations firmly in participants' own voice.

Findings

The thematic analysis revealed systematic ways through which *Dalit mukhiyas* experienced subtle resistance and exclusion while exercising their constitutional authority. Despite holding elected office, participants faced persistent efforts to delegitimize their leadership and prevent substantive democratic participation.

Bureaucratic Roadblocks and Institutional Gatekeeping

Participants consistently described encounters with block officials characterized by deliberate obstruction, disrespect, and differential treatment compared to upper-caste *mukhiyas*. A participant reported:

“If there's an upper caste mukhiya... whether it's the Block Development Officer or CEO, they sit and converse well with them.”

In India, last names are often used to decipher one's caste identity. Local officers react with immediate hostility upon identifying participants' caste through surnames on official documents. One participant recounted visiting the Sub-Divisional Officer:

“When we gave the application to them, as soon as they saw our caste from our surname, they became furious, came outside and started shouting at us.”

Local officials systematically refused to meet with *Dalit mukhiyas*, creating deliberate barriers to access. Officials even declined invitations to constitutionally mandated *Gram Sabha* meetings, demonstrating systematic avoidance of *Dalit* leadership. One participant described repeated attempts to discuss the beneficiary list of a housing scheme:

“Just two days ago, we went to meet the Block Development Officer. He refused to meet us. On the phone he asks, 'What is your issue?' We went to meet him, but he made excuses and avoided meeting us. The second day we went again, but he refused to meet.”

Information withholding emerged as a particularly insidious form of bureaucratic microaggression. Participants were deliberately kept uninformed about scheme beneficiary lists, preventing them from fulfilling their responsibilities to their constituents. This deliberate opacity undermined *mukhiya*’s authority in the eyes of villagers. One *mukhiya* described the consequences:

“I am telling you, we haven't been provided with that list yet. But public comes and asks me, 'Mukhiya ji, is my name on the list or not?' I don't have the list. I am being kept in the dark... just because of my caste... If I were upper caste, I would have gotten that list.”

File processing revealed a systematic pattern of obstructing SC *mukhiya*’s work, with approvals and NOCs delayed indefinitely for *Dalit mukhiyas* while upper-caste counterparts received prompt service. This procedural undermining made governance perpetually stalled. One participant explained:

“Our BDO... for last many years, he hasn't done any work of ours until today. Especially when he hears our name, whichever file of ours goes on his table, he'll keep it pending. The matter is definitely based on caste.”

Social Microaggressions and Symbolic Delegitimization

Community members employed various tactics to undermine the dignity and authority of Scheduled Caste *mukhiyas* through social exclusion, derogatory language, and questioning their legitimacy. Despite holding elected office, participants continued to be addressed with caste-based slurs. One participant recalled attending a death ceremony where he was initially welcomed:

“[...] But other people from Yadav community came down from the roof and were abusing the host very much. They clearly said, 'When you had to feed Chamars, you shouldn't have invited us.’”

Another participant described overhearing whispered comments:

“People don't talk upfront but behind your back. This is how people would say, 'isn't he a Chamar?'”

Despite legally abolishing untouchability, food-related purity-based discrimination still persists in various parts of India. At a social function, objections arose when a Scheduled Caste *mukhiya* handled food distribution. Even when hosts defended *mukhiya*'s role, guests pressured them to remove him from handling food. The participant recalled the incident of managing food distribution at a crowded event:

“I was handling food distribution on the request of the host, as they were busy. But some guests, I suppose... they felt that this bloody Chamar is handling our food. So, then they went to the host and asked to make me stop distributing food.”

Newly elected Scheduled Caste *mukhiyas* faced initial social boycotts, with community members deliberately avoiding official interactions. This refusal to approach a *Dalit mukhiya* signals community's preconceptions about SC leader's ability to govern and solve their problems. One participant explained: *“They wouldn't come to me for any work initially.”*

Economic status became weaponized to question capability to running for office. During electoral campaigns, a few upper-caste people emphasized lack of financial resources to delegitimize candidacy:

“People would tell me that... suppose tomorrow someone from our village met with an accident, admitted to the hospital and needs ₹10,000, how will you give them the money? When a person becomes mukhiya, you are supposed to stand up in such situations and help people.”

False accusations and character assassination emerged as systematic strategies to delegitimize *Dalit mukhiyas*. One participant described multiple complaints filed against them by their own ward members:

“People from Yadav community accused that mukhiya is acting arbitrarily, withdrawing money as he pleases, he doesn't listen to us... So, two-three times these people filed complaints to the district officer. After that, investigation happened, and nothing came out.”

Elite Strategies to Maintain Control

When facing a *Dalit* candidate who cannot be controlled, village elites resorted to electoral violence. Electoral violence includes barging into polling stations, seizure of voting instruments and fabricating votes, or intimidating voters to coerce electoral choices for or against particular candidate. Booth capturing, voter intimidation and intoxication represent direct assaults on democratic processes when elite preferences diverged from electoral outcomes. One participant described efforts to defeat him in the election:

“[...] this time, some people from Yadav community tried their best to loot booths to defeat me. They knew I won't lose in fair voting, so get the public drunk and loot the voting booths.”

After *mukhiya* post comes under reservation, upper-caste elites commonly expect that the elected *Dalit mukhiya* should function as their puppet. Elite capture in Panchayati Raj Institutions has been extensively documented from both caste and gender perspectives. One participant articulated this starkly: *“They want a person who will sign where they ask him to, he will do whatever they ask; they want a mukhiya who dances on their tune... They want to create a puppet out of them...”*

Another participant estimated that among reserved *mukhiyas*:

“If there are one hundred reserved mukhiyas, only five will be those who make independent decisions. The remaining are only allowed to talk or announce whatever decisions their masters take.”

This reveals how widespread proxy arrangements reduce political reservations largely symbolic, without intended substantive empowerment.

Resistance to Ambedkar’s Symbols and Rights Assertion

Dr. Ambedkar is revered as the foremost leader of anti-caste movement who championed *Dalit* rights and social equality. Opposition to public commemoration of Dr. Ambedkar emerged as a particularly revealing dimension of upper-caste resistance. One participant protested that before him taking the office, Ambedkar's presence was entirely erased from the panchayat office. When asked if Ambedkar's photograph was in the office before 2016, he stated simply: *“No, there was no trace of it.”*

After damaging Ambedkar’s statue in a community building twice, some people have threatened to destroy village gate, if it’s named after Ambedkar. A participant states that these are not merely acts of opposition to Ambedkar’s symbols, but resistance to substantive empowerment of *Dalits* and their rights assertion.

Discussion

This study reveals systematic mechanisms through which substantive democracy is undermined for Scheduled Caste *mukhiyas* in rural Bihar despite constitutional guarantees of formal authority. Political quotas successfully create procedural representation but encounter persistent resistance from upper-caste elites through discrimination, exclusion and intimidation. These findings contribute to how independent *Dalit* leaders continuously negotiate authority against entrenched caste hierarchies.

The bureaucratic microaggressions and exclusion extend Comisso’s (1997) distinction between procedural and substantive democracy by revealing specific mechanisms that make formal authority ineffective. Local officials’ refusals to meet *Dalit* village presidents, deliberate information withholding, and indefinite work approval delays demonstrate how bureaucratic gatekeeping prevents translation of constitutional authority into actual governance capacity. This challenges the assumption that procedural reforms automatically produce substantive empowerment (Waheduzzaman et al., 2018; Rajasekhar et al., 2018; Teltumbde, 2011). Former upper-caste *mukhiyas* and local bureaucrats often maintain close ties and informal networks built over years. When *Dalit mukhiyas* come to power, administrative apparatus actively resists power

redistribution. Participants' explicit acknowledgment that upper-caste *mukhiyas* receive prompt meetings, information access, and swift work approvals highlights how caste identity determines bureaucratic treatment rather than official position. This aligns with Behera's (2011) argument that prevailing socioeconomic systems make it exceptionally challenging for *Dalit* representatives to function effectively.

The social microaggressions demonstrate how Sue et al.'s (2007) microaggression framework applies to caste-based discrimination. Caste slurs persisting three years into tenure and food-related discrimination based on untouchability practices (*microassault*), and capability questioning based on economic status (*microinsults*) collectively function to demoralize and delegitimize Scheduled Caste leadership without direct violence. Initial reluctance by upper-caste villagers to approach *Dalit mukhiyas* illuminate how communities enact informal sanctions based on person's identity (*microinvalidation*). Scheduled Caste *mukhiyas* must prove legitimacy through prolonged competence demonstration while upper-caste counterparts enjoy presumed authority or merit. False accusations and character assassination reveal how traditional hierarchy coordinate discrediting efforts against assertive *Dalit* leaders, aligning with Cullen et al.'s (2024) findings on backlash mechanisms. Cases of obstructing development work in *Dalit* settlements and violence against assertive women *Dalit mukhiyas* (Rao, 2017; Rao, 2018b; Behera, 2011; Nagaraj, 2021) are common. This demonstrates how resistance intensifies when SC leaders materially benefit their communities, hence threatening resource monopolies which were results of elite dominance.

Fierce resistance to Ambedkar symbols and rights awareness provides empirical support for Teltumbde's (2011) theoretical argument about why dominant castes resist substantive empowerment of marginalized community. Complete erasure of Ambedkar's presence from panchayat office, subsequent statue destruction, and threatening to destroy the structure reveal that anti-caste symbols, such as Ambedkar, itself threatens traditional hierarchies. When one participant explained: "[...] *They don't want citizens' rights to be clearly told to everyone in Gram Sabha on a mic.*" This underscores how dissemination of public knowledge on constitutional rights through official platforms directly threatens information monopolies enabling exploitation of oppressed caste groups. This suggests that Scheduled Caste leaders combining Ambedkarite symbolism with rights awareness efforts face particularly intense resistance.

Elite strategies documented in this study demonstrate how traditionally dominant groups adapt to preserve dominance despite institutional reforms, extending Heinze's (2025) findings on elite tactical flexibility. The strategic identification and placement of compliant proxy candidates reveal how formal reservation compliance coexists with continued elite control over actual decision-making (Waheduzzaman et al., 2018; Rajasekhar et al., 2018). Electoral fraud and violence when facing autonomous SC candidates demonstrate how democratic processes themselves become contested terrain, with elites employing direct coercion when proxy arrangements fail to

materialize (Teltumbde, 2011). However, while extreme cases of physical violence against assertive *Dalit* leaders like Krishnaveni (Rao, 2017) garner attention and documentation, the everyday mechanisms of elite backlash – microaggressions, bureaucratic obstruction, social exclusion, and psychological intimidation – remain largely unquantified and understudied. Further systematic research is needed to document the prevalence and severity of these subtle yet pervasive forms of resistance that operate continuously to undermine *Dalit mukhiyas*' substantive authority, moving beyond anecdotal evidence to establish the scope and patterns of caste-based backlash in local governance across different contexts.

Bibliography

- Ambedkar, B. R. (2004). *The Essential Writings of B. R. Ambedkar*, ed. Valerian Rodrigues. Oxford University Press. India. 459-469.
- Behera, B. (2011). *Dalit Women's Political Empowerment Through Panchayati Raj System in India*. *Voice of Dalit*, 4(2), 215–226. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0974354520110207>
- Berry, M. E., Bouka, Y., & Kamuru, M. M. (2020). Implementing Inclusion: gender quotas, inequality, and backlash in Kenya. *Politics & Gender*, 17(4), 640–664. <https://doi.org/10.1017/s1743923x19000886>
- Braun, V., & Clarke, V. (2006). Using thematic analysis in psychology. *Qualitative Research in Psychology*, 3(2), 77–101. <https://doi.org/10.1191/1478088706qp063oa>
- Comisso, E. (1997). Is the Glass Half Full or Half Empty? Reflections on Five Years of Competitive Politics in Eastern Europe. *Communist and Post-Communist Studies*, 30(1), 1–21. <http://www.jstor.org/stable/45301997>
- Cullen, C., Joshi, S., Vecchi, J., Talbot-Jones, J. (2024). Female Empowerment and Male Backlash: Experimental Evidence from India. IZA Discussion Papers, No. 17450, Institute of Labor Economics (IZA), Bonn
- Ericsson, S. (2020). Backlash: Undesirable Effects of Female Economic Empowerment. Working Paper, No. 2019:12. Lund University, School of Economics and Management, Department of Economics, Lund
- Erten, B., & Keskin, P. (2018). For better or for worse?: Education and the prevalence of domestic violence in Turkey. *American Economic Journal Applied Economics*, 10(1), 64–105. <https://doi.org/10.1257/app.20160278>
- George, Siddharth & Rao, Vijayendra & Sharan, M. R., 2024. "Two Hundred and Fifty-Thousand Democracies: A Review of Village Government in India," Policy Research Working Paper Series 10793, The World Bank.
- Heinze, A. R. (2025). Democratic Deepening or Elite Persistence? How Local Elites Adapt to Electoral Reform in Rural India. *American Political Science Review*, 1–20.
- Heinze, A. R., Brulé, R. E., & Chauchard, S. (2025). Who actually governs? Gender inequality and political representation in rural India. *The Journal of Politics*, 87(2), 818-822.
- Mansbridge, J., & Shames, S. L. (2008). Toward a theory of backlash: dynamic resistance and the central role of power. *Politics & Gender*, 4(4), 623–634. <https://doi.org/10.1017/s1743923x08000500>

- Nagaraj, A. (2021, January 4). Denied a chair, *Dalit* women confront discrimination on Indian village councils. Reuters. <https://www.reuters.com/article/world/denied-a-chair-dalit-women-confront-discrimination-on-indian-village-councils-idUSKBN2991QJ>
- Patton, M. Q. (2002). *Qualitative research and evaluation methods* (3rd ed.). Sage Publications.
- Rajasekhar, D., Babu, M. D., & Manjula, R. (2018). Decentralised governance, development programmes and elite capture. <https://doi.org/10.1007/978-981-13-1900-6>
- Rao, B. (2017, March 8). Krishnaveni's Story And The Era Of Women Panchayat Presidents. Indiaspend. <https://www.indiaspend.com/krishnavenis-story-and-the-era-of-women-panchayat-presidents-98310>
- Rao, B. (2018b, April 21). Tamil Nadu's Women Leaders Live, Work In The Shadow Of Violence. Indiaspend. <https://www.indiaspend.com/tamil-nadus-women-leaders-live-work-in-the-shadow-of-violence-95289>
- Spicker, P. (2008). Government for the people: the substantive elements of democracy. *International Journal of Social Welfare*, 17(3), 251–259. <https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1468-2397.2008.00556.x>
- Sue, D. W., Capodilupo, C. M., Torino, G. C., Bucceri, J. M., Holder, A. M., Nadal, K. L., & Esquilin, M. (2007). Racial microaggressions in everyday life: implications for clinical practice. *The American psychologist*, 62(4), 271–286. <https://doi.org/10.1037/0003-066X.62.4.271>
- Teltumbde, A. (2011). India's (Jati) Panchayati Raj. *Economic and Political Weekly*, 46(36), 10–11.
- Waheduzzaman, W., As-Saber, S., & Hamid, M. B. (2018). Elite capture of local participatory governance. *Policy & Politics*, 46(4), 645–662. <https://doi.org/10.1332/030557318x15296526896531>